MTM4681 · PROJECT MILESTONE 1 · REPORT

Koru: Flutter app

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Repo: github.com/muhammetkeremaydin/koru-mobile-app
Figma: figma.com/design/XKC6fYGfZ3pcLfCgGDakab
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1. Problem and users

Who: small, private, in-person book clubs of roughly 5–15 people who meet on a fixed rhythm (weekly or every two weeks) and read in Turkish. One or two organizers do the planning; everyone else mainly needs to know when and where the next meeting is, say whether they are coming, and share what they thought of the book.

Pain, every week: such clubs usually run on a messaging group plus a shared spreadsheet. The meeting time and place get buried in chat; nobody knows how many people are coming; ratings and comments are scattered or lost; choosing the next book becomes a long thread; and a year later nobody remembers what was read, when, and how it was rated. The organizer does all the bookkeeping by hand.

Evidence: the problem is common enough that dedicated organizer apps exist. Bookclubs, the market leader, was created to free one Philadelphia club from never-ending email chains and now serves thousands of clubs. Yet none of the apps in Section 2 offers a Turkish interface built around in-person meetings, which is the gap Koru targets.

Goal: one place where a member can, in under ten seconds, see the next meeting, say *Geliyorum*, rate the book after the meeting and vote for the next one, with the club's whole history kept automatically.

2. Existing apps and where they fall short

App	What it does well	Gap for a small, in-person Turkish club
Bookclubs	The most complete club organizer: polls for books and meeting times, calendar invites and reminders, message boards, a shelf of the club's reading history.	English-only interface; useful extras are paid per club (Premium ≈ $5/month: extra poll types, DMs, multiple admins, calendar sync; video and RSVP limits only on Pro Plus). Ratings are per book, not per meeting.
Fable	Social reading: large public club directory, spoiler-safe chapter discussion, highlights and reactions while reading, reading stats.	Built around *virtual*, often public clubs and its e-book store; little support for physical meetings (place, time, who is coming). Paid Plus tier, owned by Scribd.
The StoryGraph	Excellent personal reading tracker and stats; since 2024 also book clubs with meeting agendas, a question bank, date/book polls and buddy reads.	Club tools are an add-on to a personal tracker and centre on agendas, question banks and polls; there is no attendance, per-meeting rating record or photo album.
Goodreads	Biggest catalogue and review base; Groups with discussion boards and group reads.	Group tools are basic and have barely changed in years; no meetings, RSVP or voting flow. Owned by Amazon.
Bookship	Private group chat around a book, spoiler tags, calendars, built-in video meetings.	Chat-first and less focused on administration; no structured ratings, votes or history.
1000Kitap (TR)	Turkey's large book social network since 2012: personal library, reading goals, reviews and quotes, in Turkish, free with ad-free Premium.	Personal and public by design; it does not describe club meetings, RSVPs or group voting.
WhatsApp + Sheets	Everyone already has it; zero setup; chat is immediate.	No structure: decisions, attendance and ratings disappear in the message stream; manual work for the organizer.

3. Koru's position: what we add, and what we deliberately leave out

Our advantages

- **Meeting-centred, not book-centred.** The home screen is always "this week / next meeting". A long book can span several sessions (continuation meetings), each with its own chapter range and reviews.
- **RSVP separate from attendance.** "Geliyorum" is a plan; after the meeting the admin records who actually came. RSVP closes at the end of meeting day.
- **Per-meeting reviews:** reading status (read / partly / not read), page reached, 1–10 rating and comment,

Where competitors are stronger (honest limits)

- **No discovery:** you cannot find public clubs or strangers; Koru is for an existing circle.
- **No in-app chat or video:** conversation stays in WhatsApp; Koru holds the decisions and the record.
- **Smaller catalogue:** Open Library is weak for Turkish books, so some titles are entered by hand; no review database like Goodreads or 1000Kitap.
- **No e-reader, highlights or reading stats** like Fable or StoryGraph.

with the meeting average. This is richer than a 5-star book rating.
- **Fair book choice for free:** one active vote per member, open or secret voting, and a voted book moves to the calendar in one step.
- **Turkish-first:** Turkish UI, dates ("Per, 14 Kas · 19:30") and accent-insensitive search; manual book entry when the Open Library catalogue misses a Turkish title.
- **Private and quiet:** no ads, no public feed, no followers; access is limited to group members by Firebase Security Rules. One account can belong to several circles.
- **A distinct visual identity** (the "Defter" notebook look) instead of a generic social-app template, in light and dark mode.

- **No photos or push notifications in the MVP:** both need paid Firebase services (Cloud Storage requires the Blaze plan; push needs Cloud Functions).
- **Small team:** Android is our main test target; iOS is verified only where a Mac is available.

> These limits are scope choices for a two-person, one-term project. The chat/video gap is intentional: clubs already have a chat app, but none of them has a reliable *record*.

4. Main features and course topics

#	Feature	Screens	Course topic
1	Sign in and choose a group	01–02	Firebase Auth, navigation
2	Home page with the next meeting; meeting list with search	03–04	Layouts, lists, bottom tabs
3	Meeting page: who is coming, favorite, share, add to calendar	05	Cloud Firestore (live data)
4	Review form: page reached, rating 1–10, short comment	06	Forms and validation, MVVM
5	Vote on the next book; suggest a book from Open Library	07–08	HTTP and JSON, Provider
6	Profile with stats and dark mode; past meetings also work offline	04, 09	Local DB (SQLite), theming, animation

5. What we hand in

Item	Where
Design justification	`docs/design-justification.pdf`
User flow	`docs/user-flow.pdf`
Wireframes (11 screens)	Figma *01 Wireframes*, `design/wireframes/`
Mockups (11 light, 11 dark)	Figma *02 Mockups & Styles*, `design/mockups/`
Clickable prototype	Figma *03 Prototype* (link in `README.md`)
Architecture and protocols	`docs/architecture-protocols.pdf`
Extra: local database code with tests	`lib/data/`, `test/local/`

Sources (accessed November 2026): Bookclubs: App Store listing and bookclubs.com/premium-pricing; Firebase: Cloud Storage pricing-plan FAQ; Fable: fable.co and makeheadway.com/blog/fable-vs-goodreads; The StoryGraph: roadmap.thestorygraph.com/changelog/book-clubs- and help article on buddy reads; Goodreads Groups: bookwise "Goodreads app guide"; Bookship: App Store listing; 1000Kitap: App Store listing (id1319837589).